

Psalms 105

Remember His Marvelous Works

Seek the Lord, and his strength: seek his face evermore. Remember his marvellous works

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 O give thanks unto the LORD; call upon his name: make known his deeds among the people.
- 2 Sing unto him, sing psalms unto him: talk ye of all his wondrous works.
- 3 Glory ye in his holy name: let the heart of them rejoice that seek the LORD.
- 4 Seek the LORD, and his strength: seek his face evermore.
- 5 Remember his marvellous works that he hath done; his wonders, and the judgments of his mouth;
- 6 O ye seed of Abraham his servant, ye children of Jacob his chosen.
- 7 He is the LORD our God: his judgments are in all the earth.
- 8 He hath remembered his covenant for ever, the word which he commanded to a thousand generations.
- 9 Which covenant he made with Abraham, and his oath unto Isaac;
- 10 And confirmed the same unto Jacob for a law, and to Israel for an everlasting covenant:
- 11 Saying, Unto thee will I give the land of Canaan, the lot of your inheritance:
- 12 When they were but a few men in number; yea, very few, and strangers in it.
- 13 When they went from one nation to another, from one kingdom to another people;
- 14 He suffered no man to do them wrong: yea, he reprov'd kings for their sakes;
- 15 Saying, Touch not mine anointed, and do my prophets no harm.
- 16 Moreover he called for a famine upon the land: he brake the whole staff of bread.
- 17 He sent a man before them, even Joseph, who was sold for a servant:
- 18 Whose feet they hurt with fetters: he was laid in iron:
- 19 Until the time that his word came: the word of the LORD tried him.
- 20 The king sent and loosed him; even the ruler of the people, and let him go free.
- 21 He made him lord of his house, and ruler of all his substance:
- 22 To bind his princes at his pleasure; and teach his senators wisdom.
- 23 Israel also came into Egypt; and Jacob sojourned in the land of Ham.
- 24 And he increased his people greatly; and made them stronger than their enemies.
- 25 He turned their heart to hate his people, to deal subtilly with his servants.
- 26 He sent Moses his servant; and Aaron whom he had chosen.
- 27 They shewed his signs among them, and wonders in the land of Ham.
- 28 He sent darkness, and made it dark; and they rebelled not against his word.
- 29 He turned their waters into blood, and slew their fish.
- 30 Their land brought forth frogs in abundance, in the chambers of their kings.
- 31 He spake, and there came divers sorts of flies, and lice in all their coasts.
- 32 He gave them hail for rain, and flaming fire in their land.
- 33 He smote their vines also and their fig trees; and brake the trees of their coasts.
- 34 He spake, and the locusts came, and caterpillars, and that without number,
- 35 And did eat up all the herbs in their land, and devoured the fruit of their ground.
- 36 He smote also all the firstborn in their land, the chief of all their strength.
- 37 He brought them forth also with silver and gold: and there was not one feeble person among their tribes.
- 38 Egypt was glad when they departed: for the fear of them fell upon them.
- 39 He spread a cloud for a covering; and fire to give light in the night.
- 40 The people asked, and he brought quails, and satisfied them with the bread of heaven.
- 41 He opened the rock, and the waters gushed out; they ran in the dry places like a river.
- 42 For he remembered his holy promise, and Abraham his servant.

- 43 And he brought forth his people with joy, and his chosen with gladness:
44 And gave them the lands of the heathen: and they inherited the labour of the people;
45 That they might observe his statutes, and keep his laws. Praise ye the LORD.

2 · CONTEXT

Psalm 105 retells Israel's history from the covenant with Abraham through the exodus and the gift of the land as a sustained argument for God's covenant faithfulness, deliberately omitting the nation's failures (which Psalm 106 will supply) to focus entirely on what God did and kept. Henry treats this selective retelling as itself instructive: sometimes remembrance needs to focus purely on gratitude before it turns to honest confession, and this psalm models the former while its companion models the latter.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-6

The call to worship is active and specific: give thanks, call on His name, make known His deeds among the people, sing psalms, talk of His wondrous works, glory in His holy name. Seeking is described as ongoing—seek the Lord and His strength, seek His face evermore—rooted in identity as the seed of Abraham, the chosen ones.

Verse 7-11

God's identity and covenant are stated directly: He is the Lord our God, whose judgments extend through all the earth. He is said to have remembered His covenant forever, the word commanded to a thousand generations, made specifically with Abraham, confirmed to Isaac, and established to Jacob as an everlasting covenant, with the land of Canaan as the appointed inheritance.

Verse 12-15

The patriarchs' vulnerability is named honestly: few in number, strangers in the land, wandering from nation to nation, from one kingdom to another. Yet God suffered no one to wrong them, rebuking kings on their behalf, warning even powerful rulers: touch not my anointed ones, do my prophets no harm—protection extended precisely because of their weakness, not their strength.

Verse 16-22

Joseph's story is recounted as evidence of providence working through hardship: famine called upon the land, the staff of bread broken, but a man sent before them—Joseph, sold into slavery, his feet hurt with fetters, laid in irons—until the appointed time when his word came true and the king released him, making him lord of his house and ruler over his substance, wise enough to instruct even the king's own counselors.

Verse 23-27

Israel's move into Egypt and subsequent growth is recalled: Jacob sojourning in the land of Ham, the people increasing greatly, growing stronger than their enemies, whose hearts God then turned to hate and deal subtly with them. In response, God sent Moses and Aaron, His chosen ones, who performed His signs and wonders in the land of Ham.

Verse 28-36

The plagues are recounted in vivid succession: darkness sent, waters turned to blood killing the fish, frogs filling the land, flies and lice swarming at God's word, hail and fire ruining vines and fig trees, locusts and caterpillars devouring what remained, and finally the firstborn struck down—the full might of the strongest empire of the age broken systematically.

Verse 37-41

The exodus itself is celebrated: Israel brought out with silver and gold, no feeble one among their tribes, Egypt glad to see them go because fear of them had fallen upon the land. A cloud provided covering, fire gave light by night; when they asked, quail came and bread from heaven satisfied them; the rock was opened and waters gushed out, running like a river in the dry places.

Verse 42-45

The psalm closes by returning to its starting point: God remembered His holy promise to Abraham His servant, bringing His people out with joy and gladness, giving them the lands of nations so they might inherit the labor of others—all so that they would observe His statutes and keep His laws. The final word is simply: praise the Lord.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Deliberately rehearsing God's specific, historical faithfulness—covenant kept, providence at work even through hardship like Joseph's, deliverance accomplished against overwhelming odds—is its own act of worship, distinct from and prior to confession of failure. The purpose of all this remembered history is stated plainly at the end: not merely national pride, but that God's people would actually observe His statutes and keep His laws in response.

Application for life today.

Set aside time to rehearse God's specific faithfulness in your own history—concrete events, not vague feelings—the way this psalm rehearses Israel's, before moving to confession or request. Notice how Joseph's hardship (vv. 17–22) is folded into providence rather than treated as contradicting it; consider what current difficulty might likewise be part of a longer story you cannot yet see the end of. Remember that the purpose of remembering, per verse 45, is obedience, not merely nostalgia—let gratitude for the past lead to concrete faithfulness now.

5 • REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What specific, concrete act of God's faithfulness in your own history deserves the kind of deliberate rehearsal this psalm gives Israel's story, rather than vague gratitude?

2. How does Joseph's hardship being folded into God's providence (vv. 17–22), rather than treated as contradicting it, reshape how you view a current difficulty?

3. Verse 45 states the purpose of remembering as obedience—what specific 'statute' or faithful practice should your own remembered gratitude actually produce?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).